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ENCINO ENTERPRISE

Volume 7, Issue 152 | A Compendious Source of Information | October 1,2026

NEWS IN BRIEF

Legal Update on Encino "Party House"

Neighborhoods First, together with local homeowners, has filed a lawsuit for Public and Private Nuisance against the owner of the "Party House" property at 4434 Grimes Place for allowing numerous illegal uses over the last several years that have included large, unruly gatherings with amplified music, traffic chaos, accidents, assaults, a robbery and other unlawful conduct. LAPD has issued numerous citations and the property owner, Dr. Marjan Garmestani, ignored warnings to stop allowing illegal events which are promoted on social media and include shuttles taking people to the parties. While this case is still pending, the LA Superior Court granted Judgment which included a permanent injunction prohibiting large, unruly gatherings and other commercial uses in violation of zoning and related laws at another Encino party house at 4777 White Oak Ave.

San Fernando Valley Audubon Society to Provide Five Scholarships

The San Fernando Valley Audubon Society (SFVAS) will award five scholarships of $1,000 each to local college students who are pursuing studies in ornithology, ecology and conservation. These funds are to be used to help defray the costs of education and to help the next generation of birding and conservation enthusiasts and scientists achieve their professional goals. The scholarship includes membership in the SFVAS, asks that the student participate in at least one SFVAS activity (for example, the Christmas Bird Count), and includes a seat at the annual spring luncheon. To apply, write a simple statement of what your interests are, your experiences and how you think you will be contributing to conservation, ecology, or birds in the future. Submit proof of enrollment at a local college and your contact information to Marianne Davis by the end of November 2026, at M54wdavis@gmail.com.

National Coffee with a Cop Day to be Held on October 7

Join the Encino Neighborhood Council and officers from the LAPD West Valley Division for National Coffee With a Cop Day on Wednesday, October 7, from 11 to 12:30 pm. Whether you pop in or stay for the whole event, this is an ideal opportunity to meet local officers, ask questions pertaining to your community concerns and build local connections. This event will take place at The Coffee Bean & Tea Leaf at 17301 Ventura Blvd. in Encino.

November 3 Election Preview

In this issue we bring you a preview of the November 3 election: who is running for what office that affects the valley.

Our election coverage will continue this month with candidate Q&A's and candidate statements. We have invited all candidates to submit advertising and editorial and will post these throughout October to educate and inform our readers.

CANDIDATES FOR CITY OF LOS ANGELES MAYOR



Candidate:
KAREN BASS

Party:
Democrat

Current Job:
Mayor of the City of Los Angeles



Candidate:
NITHYA RAMA

Party:
Democrat

Current Job:
Los Angeles City Councilmember District 4

CANDIDATES FOR UNITED STATES CONGRESS



Candidate:
BRAD SHERMAN

Party:
Democrat

Current Job:
United States Congressman 32nd District



Candidate:
LARRY THOMPSON

Party:
Republican

Current Job:
President & CEO Larry Thompson Entertainment

CANDIDATES FOR CALIFORNIA ASSEMBLY DISTRICT 46



Candidate:
JESSE GABRIEL

Party:
Democrat

Current Job:
California State Assemblymember District 46



Candidate:
TRACY SCHROEDER

Party:
Republican

Current Job:
Teacher

CALENDAR



Community Calendar

* The Encino Neighborhood Council will host a Movie Night on Saturday, October 10, at 5:30 pm at Encino Park. This free community event will have activities for kids, popcorn, family fun and of course, a screening of a family-friendly movie.

* It's time to get ready for Halloween! Join the Encino Tarzana Library on Thursday, October 8, at 4:30 pm to learn how to draw one or two characters from the *Addams Family* animated series. Evan Burse will walk participants through the drawing process step by step. If you decide to draw a life-size (or almost life-size) character, you'll have a chance to transfer your drawing onto a foam board and display it in the library. This program is for those aged 11–19.

* Join the Sherman Oaks Encino Chamber for the Community Disaster Preparedness Committee on Wednesday, October 7, from 2 to 3 pm. Find out how to take the lead to prepare the community for the next big disaster/emergency. They ask that you embrace personal responsibility to be prepared; to get training in first aid and emergency skills; and to volunteer to support local emergency responders, disaster relief efforts, and increase community safety. For more information on this virtual meeting, see shermanoaksencinochamber.org.

* The American Red Cross, in partnership with Westfield Fashion Square, will host a blood drive on Tuesday, October 13, from 11 am to 3 pm. Book your appointment at redcrossblood.org.

* The San Fernando Valley Audubon Society is hosting a beginner bird walk of the Sepulveda Basin on Sunday, October 11, from 9 to 11 am. This walk is perfect for beginning birdwatchers, families with school-age children or people who want to visit and learn more about the wildlife reserve. Tours last approximately one-and-a-half to two hours. For more info, and meet up details, visit sfvaudubon.org/event/beginner-bird-walk-at-sepulveda-basin-3/2026-10-11.

* Manzanita School will hold their forest kindergarten open house for children age four and older on Saturday, October 10, from 9 to 11 am. Manzanita School offers a transformative K–12 education for students ages four and up, uniting academic excellence with a deep connection to the natural world. At the heart of Manzanita's philosophy is its Forest Kindergarten—the only program of its kind in LA—where young learners explore forests, streams, and meadows through play, curiosity, and discovery. This intentional, research-based approach builds confidence, creativity, and social emotional intelligence, laying the foundation for lifelong learning. Manzanita is located at 1717 Old Topanga Canyon Road. For more information or to register for the open house visit manzanitaschool.com.

* The Encino Neighborhood Council will host their Public Safety Committee meeting on Monday, October 12, at 7 pm. The meeting will take place at the Encino Community Center at 4935 Balboa Blvd. For more info, visit encinonc.org.

* A representative from Alzheimer's LA will visit the West Valley Regional Library on Saturday, October 3, from 10 am to 12 pm to discuss the basic knowledge, skills and attitudes needed to care for someone with Alzheimer's disease or another dementia during this three-week program. All attendees will receive a free caregiver manual and a certificate of completion after attending all three sessions. Space is limited. To register, contact the branch at 818-345-9806.

* Save the date for Tarzana Community & Cultural Center's annual gala on Saturday, October 17, for an exciting celebration that takes you back to the iconic swingin' 1960s era in London and experience the spirit of Carnaby Street. The evening kicks off at 5:30 pm with Jay Asher and Tiffany Bailey performing hits by Brits Tom Jones, Petula Clark, Dusty Springfield and Lulu. The cocktail hour will also feature international magic champion Brian Ochab doing magic tricks for guests. At 7 pm dinner will be served and you'll be treated to the music of Celter Skelter - The Irish-Celtic Beatles Experience, featuring frontman Joseph Eid! There will also be a live auction. Tickets are $200 and can be purchased at mytarzana.org.





People in the News



Jordan Peisner, left, and his father, **Ed Peisner**, right, celebrated with **Governor Gavin Newsom** the signing of AB 1709 into law. California law now says social media platforms may not provide addictive design features to users under 16, starting with personalized feeds and autoplay, and the Attorney General can designate additional features by regulation as platforms evolve. Platforms will have to verify users' ages, and a new e-Safety Advisory Commission will help keep these protections current. News reports today are describing it as the first law of its kind in the nation.

After a long and successful career in banking, Ed Peisner founded the Organization for Social Media Safety in 2017 following a tragic incident involving his teenage son Jordan, who was brutally assaulted in West Hills, leaving Jordan with severe, lifelong injuries. The attack was recorded and shared on social media, where it went viral. In response, Peisner dedicated himself to ensuring that no other family would endure such a devastating experience.

He travels the country educating students, parents, and educators on essential social media safety skills. Through his impactful and research-driven presentations, he has reached hundreds of thousands of individuals at schools and community organizations across the United States.

Pesiner said, "Today was one of the most significant days for children's safety since social media began. AB 1709 was one of 13 bills the Governor signed to protect children on social media and AI, and the Organization for Social Media Safety was proud to support these measures."



Lumberjack Lance (né Lance Pecht) broke his own world record on September 20, with a whopping 36 grappler pull-ups in one minute. A grappler pull-up is a more grueling pull-up where you hold lacrosse balls in each hand over a bar with the wrists hanging over the bar.

The 6'4", 235-pound athlete from Spokane, Washington traveled here to the Valley to break his own record on his favorite pull-up bars facing the heart of the Valley: Ventura Blvd.

Lance Pecht, above right, and BUF studio owner Natalie Joseph, left.

English Channel



By Rodger Sterling

English Channel offers the best of the late editor Rodger Sterling's columns that ran continuously in the local papers since 1968.

We love these gems that highlight the absurdity of the English language:

We'll begin with a box, and the plural is boxes,
But the plural of ox becomes oxen, not oxes.
One fowl is a goose, but two are called geese,
Yet the plural of moose should never be meese.
You may find a lone mouse or a nest full of mice,
Yet the plural of house is houses, not hice.
If the plural of man is always called men,
Why shouldn't the plural of pan be called pen?
If I speak of my foot and show you my feet,
And I give you a boot, would a pair be called beet?
If one is a tooth and a whole set are teeth,
Why shouldn't the plural of booth be called beeth?
Then one may be that, and three would be those,
Yet hat in the plural would never be hose,
And the plural of cat is cats, not cose.
We speak of a brother and also of brethren,
But though we say mother, we never say methren.
Then the masculine pronouns are he, his and him,
But imagine the feminine: she, shis and shim!



LOCAL NEWS

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Word on the Street



By Kathleen Sterling

Every journalist that's gone to jail for not revealing a source did it for me.

Every foreign correspondent killed covering a war did it for me.

They stood up for what they believe in – and wrote about it – so I could do the same.

So I'm going to take on Trump and his latest move, banning CNN, MS NOW and Politico from the White House.

My papers focus on local news, not national, but this issue comes straight down the line to what I can and cannot write. What I can and cannot print. What you can and cannot read.

We print community news. But if your access to national news, to honest reporting, is limited to one man's interpretation, then you are longer free. And there should be no limitations. Our constitution protects freedom of speech – and freedom of the press.

Trump has put himself, once again, above the constitution to upend freedom of the press because he doesn't like "what they write about me." He has openly said about his attacks on journalists, "I do it to discredit you all and demean you all so that when you write negative stories about me no one will believe you."

This is not my United States. This is not my democracy.

This is one man subverting our constitution because of his own ego. It's one man throwing a temper tantrum because he doesn't like what someone said about him.

He banned the news organizations from what he called "the people's house." But the White House, the "people's house," is just that. It is a symbol of our democracy and a place for all Americans. It symbolizes that this country already threw off one king to become independent. It is the house of all people – not just one man who tries to use the power of his office for his own good, not the nation's.

Trump throws out the term "fake news" for every story he doesn't like. But he then turns around and posts a map on Truth Social showing Mexico, Canada, Greenland, Cuba, and other parts of the Caribbean as part of the United States. So far as I know they're still independent.

He's our president, but he's certainly not a statesmen like some stellar chief executives before him. We have a president in office who says crude things about women, makes fun of the handicapped, attacks people based on their looks, and has engendered an atmosphere of hate in this country.

He calls journalists "sick." But it's sickening to watch what he is doing to subvert the constitution to his own end.

We've had presidents who've come up against journalists. Who have had negative things written about them. Who haven't liked news coverage of their actions. But we haven't had one who so blatantly abridges the rights of journalists. Your right to read more than one opinion. Your right to disagree with me about this editorial. Your right to write a response.

Trump called the press the "enemy of the American people." But who is the real enemy? The journalists criticizing Trump? Or the one taking away the rights guaranteed to all of us in our constitution?



Van Nuys Airport Releases Economic Impact Study

Van Nuys Airport (VNY) has released an Economic Impact Study showing significant growth in the airport's contributions to the SoCal economy, including 77% more jobs, 46% more output, and 27% more labor income compared to 2015.

The study finds that VNY currently generates $3.9 billion in regional output annually, supports 18,350 jobs, contributes $1.1 billion in labor income, and adds $2.2 billion to the region's gross domestic product, making it one of the most economically significant general aviation airports in the United States. VNY is also a meaningful contributor to the region's tax base, generating $197 million in state and local tax revenue annually. The vast majority of the airport's economic impact, including 89% of employment and 81% of output, remains within LA County, with significant benefits reaching all five County Supervisorial Districts and all 15 City Council Districts.

"These numbers tell a remarkable story of investment and growth," said Jacob Haik, Airport Manager, Van Nuys Airport. "Van Nuys Airport has nearly doubled its economic footprint over the past decade, and that momentum reflects the strength of the businesses, workers, and communities that call this airport home. We're proud to be an engine of opportunity for the San Fernando Valley."

Recent infrastructure projects at VNY reflect a sustained effort to prioritize small business engagement and workforce opportunities for SoCal residents. Of the two general contractors and engineering organizations involved in the recent Van Nuys Taxiway Reconstruction Project, one is on track to meet or exceed its 15% Disadvantaged Business Enterprise goal, currently at 14.6%. At that firm, more than 80% of new hires attended schools in Southern California, while local hire policies at the second firm ensure that many employees live less than five minutes from the airfield. These statistics reflect a deliberate effort to funnel opportunities to small businesses and create job opportunities in the immediate vicinity of the airfield.

The study marks a major step forward from the last comparable economic impact analysis, conducted in 2016 by the Los Angeles Economic Development Corporation.

JOB LISTING:

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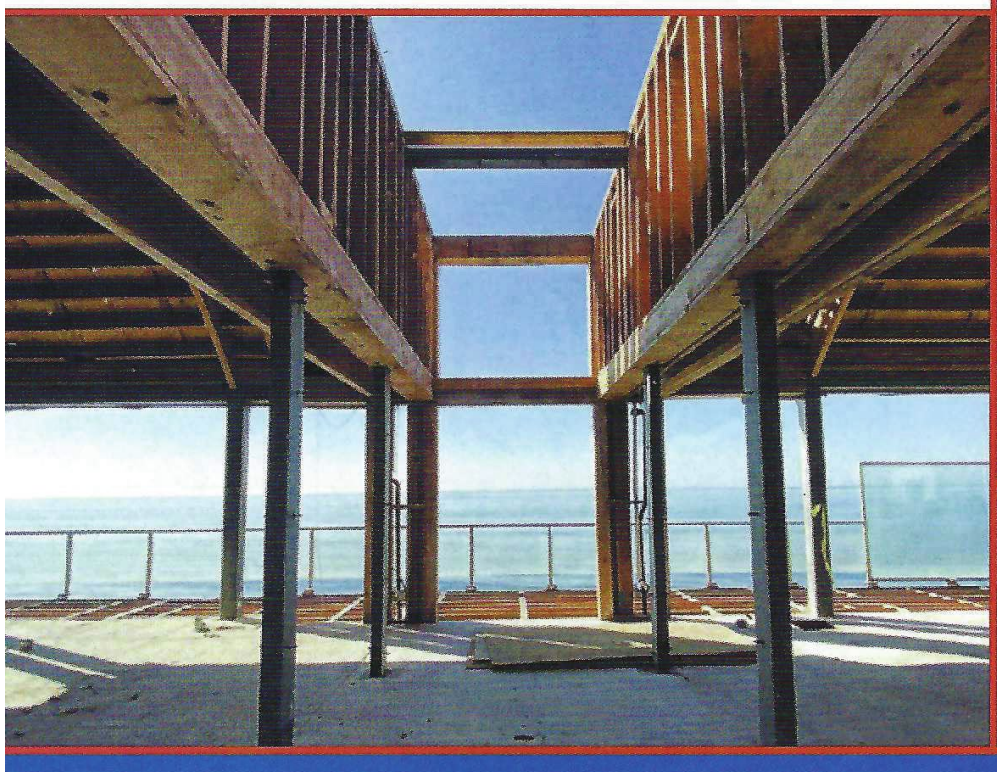
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HEALTH

California Becomes First State to Create an Official State Seal for Non-Ultraprocessed Foods



At a bill signing ceremony at UCLA Mattel Children's Hospital, California Governor Gavin Newsom signed Assembly Bill (AB) 2244, landmark legislation that will empower Californians to make better informed and healthier choices by increasing transparency around ultra-processed foods.

Authored by Assemblymember Jesse Gabriel (D-Encino), AB 2244 establishes the first-ever "Non-Ultraprocessed Certified" seal that food manufacturers can place on products that meet clear standards for not being ultra-processed. Modeled after the widely recognized "USDA Organic" label, the seal will provide consumers with a simple, trustworthy way to identify healthier options with a quick glance. The bill also will require grocery stores in California to prominently display products bearing the "Non-Ultraprocessed Certified" seal, thereby making it easier for busy families to find healthier foods quickly and conveniently.

"While Washington D.C. is paralyzed by inaction, Republicans and Democrats in California are joining forces to empower consumers to avoid harmful ultra-processed foods," said Assemblymember Gabriel. "Like the USDA Organic label, this new seal will provide consumers with clear, trustworthy information and make it easier for them to locate healthier foods that are free from harmful additives. Parents shouldn't need a Ph.D. in chemistry to understand what they're feeding their kids. California began this movement three years ago by banning the most dangerous food additives, and with Governor Newsom's continued leadership we are taking another big step forward today."

AB 2244 is the latest in a series of Gabriel-authored laws that have reshaped how California – and increasingly the country – thinks about what's in our food. Last year, Assemblymember Gabriel authored and Governor Newsom signed into law The Real Food, Healthy Kids Act (AB 1264, 2025), groundbreaking legislation which established the nation's first statutory definition of ultra-processed foods and set up a process to ban harmful products from California schools. Assemblymember Gabriel also successfully passed into law two other landmark bills with bipartisan support: the California Food Safety Act (AB 418, 2023) and the California School Food Safety Act (AB 2316, 2024). Collectively, these laws have helped change the national conversation about food additives and ultra-processed foods, shaped federal policy, and inspired similar legislation across more than 30 other states.

AB 2244 passed with support of a broad coalition that includes the Environmental Working Group, the California Medical Association, the American Academy of Pediatrics, the American Diabetes Association, the American Heart Association, the Crohn's & Colitis Foundation, and the United Nurses Associations of California. The bill passed with votes of 32-0 in the State Senate and 72-0 in the State Assembly.



AI Grossly Midunderstands Women's Health

In no surprise to any woman, research has come out that artificial intelligence doesn't understand female health. Decades of medication and disease research has largely been done via male subjects with the results being applied to women's bodies, despite having vastly different internal systems. Hormones, reproductive organs and the like can significantly factor in how symptoms appear in an individual and how treatment should be administered. Now, in a world dominated by AI, women are looking for answers for common health ailments and getting grossly inaccurate answers. Current research on the 13 state-of-the-art AI models shows that there is a 60 percent failure rate in the matter of women's health advice.

The problem is that artificial intelligence has read a slew of all online health information available to it, but that clinical research is built around the male physiology. When it delivers its findings, it does so with confidence and fluency, but lacks a disclaimer that the information is limited. The user generally reads the answers with confidence and can end up minimizing symptoms that should be further looked at. Again, this all stems back from the history of modern medicine and the benchmark of all research depending on a 154-pound Caucasian male. Menopause was one issue that wasn't even discussed in the early days of health research and women were excluded from any clinical trials until 1993.

Thus, AI knowledge is built on scientific data that is often under-researched and incorrect. For now, it lacks the complexity to understand how something like hormones can vastly change a diagnosis. For women, their hormonal cycle is approximately 28 days, for men, that cycle is just 24 hours. AI has been praised for its ability to revolutionize the medical field, but it also needs to be appropriately regulated.

While women's health has seen a major shift in recent decades, it still has a long way to go before AI can have as strong a grasp on its nuances as females themselves have. Those looking for medical advice are advised to always seek aid from their own doctor, rather than relying on the answers that the internet churns out.

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HEALTH



Middle-Schoolers Seeking Friendships with AI Over Peers

Artificial intelligence has quickly become a crutch for individuals seeking assistance in almost every aspect of their life. It's been used to self-diagnose health issues, to rewrite essays or tweak resumes, to meticulously plan vacations and much more. Now, a study has found that individuals are turning to AI for something far more personal, friendship.

In a scientific paper currently under review, researchers at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill studied over 2,300 middle-school students to see how they were relying on artificial intelligence.

"We found that two to four kids in every classroom are now reporting they prefer interaction with a chatbot over a human peer," says Mitch Prinstein, co-director of UNC's Winston Center on Technology and Brain Development and one of the study's authors. "This is a pretty existential concern for this generation."

While the study reflected that these students prefer AI over peer interaction, it also showcased that this dependence is associated with higher social anxiety and depressive symptoms. The more the students use the AI, the lonelier they become. As it's a critical time in the students' lives, when their brains are typically learning to build relationships, this reliance on AI is severing that opportunity to learn social growth.

"There's research that shows the experiences we have with peers at this age predict a whole slew of outcomes well into our 40s and 50s—things like our career advancement, marital satisfaction, child-rearing style and even our health," Prinstein says. "When kids replace human relationships with chatbots, they're missing major learning opportunities to develop the interpersonal skills they'll need for a lifetime."

The paper detailed that one in five students confessed that they used AI for intimate friendship, but also expressed their increased level of isolation from others. Since these chatbots are built to be overly agreeable, students are not experiencing what a true social connection can be like and are being fed what they essentially want to hear.

"When kids replace human relationships with chatbots, they're missing major learning opportunities to develop the interpersonal skills they'll need for a lifetime."

The increased use of AI as a relationship tool ultimately stunts empathy, decreases the ability to learn conflict resolution and paints a false picture of what a reciprocal relationship can be.

Mental health groups such as the American Psychological Association strongly encourage parents to monitor chatbot usage for children under 18 years of age. They not only stunt natural sociological growth, but can be harmful in allowing children to inadequately discern between what is real and what is manufactured.



Thyroid Medication Recall Upgraded to FDA's Most Serious Risk Level

The recall of thyroid medication distributed by Vitruvias Therapeutics Inc. has been upgraded to a Class I recall, the most critical level from the Food and Drug Administration.

Initially recalled at the end of August, the FDA has changed the warning as the drug may be super potent or stronger than intended. When taking a thyroid medication that is extremely strong, users may experience hypertension, rapid heart rate and weight loss. These symptoms are heightened in pregnant women and the elderly.

A Class I categorization of the recall indicates "that there's a reasonable probability the drugs could cause serious health consequences or death."

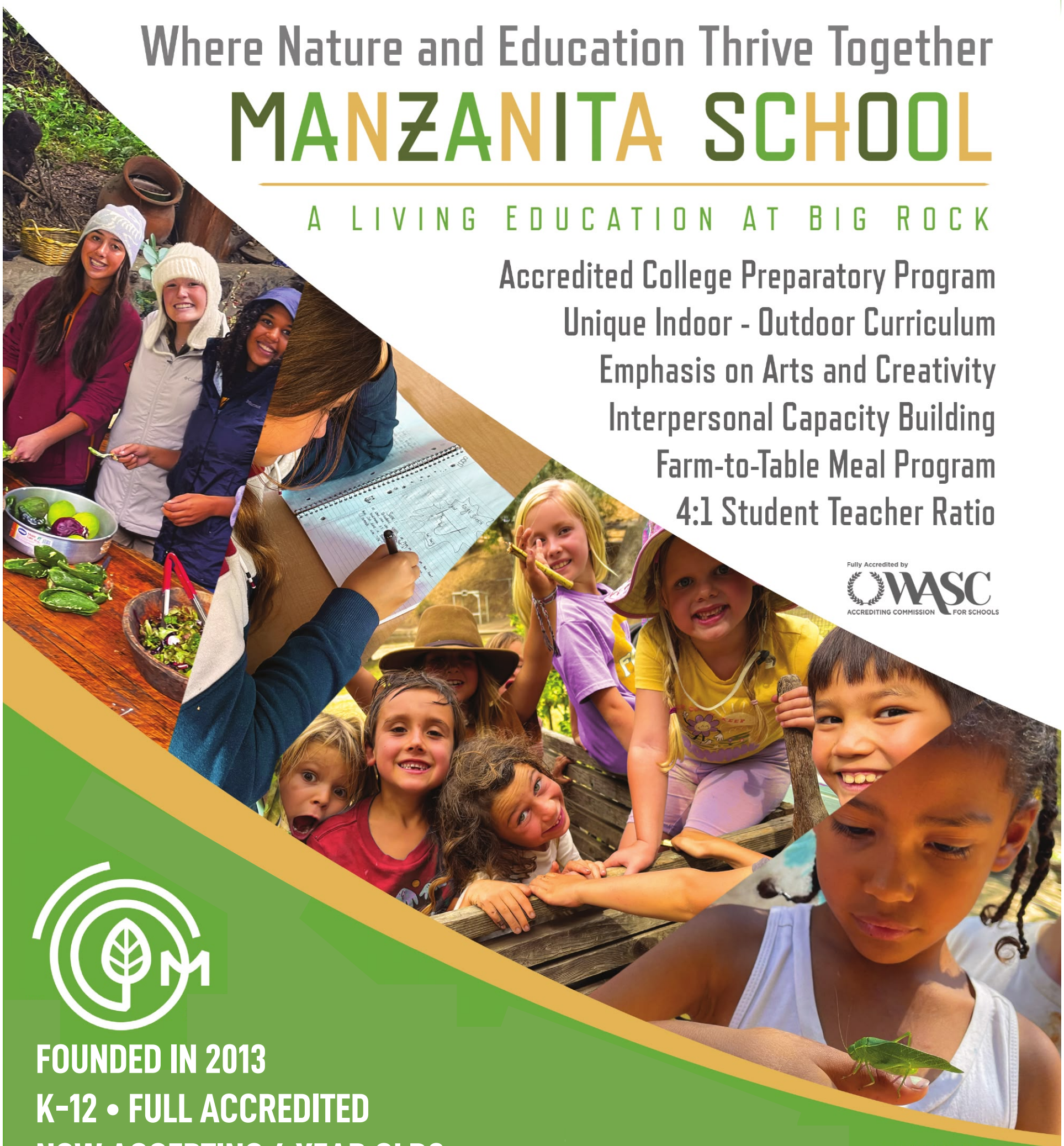
The medication is listed as Thyroid Tablets, USP, 1/2 Grain (30 mg)—each tablet contains: levothyroxine (T4) 19 mcg, liothyronine (T3) 4.5 mcg with a lot number of 504950 and a NDC number of 69680-166-00.

Vitruvias Therapeutics have notified wholesalers of the faulty medication, but if you are in possession of the affected medication, you are advised to call your health provider immediately. No adverse reactions have been reported in relation to the recalled medicine, but the FDA is exuding an abundance of caution. It is not advised to immediately stop the medication as this can have unintended consequences as well. Contact your doctor or pharmacist for direction and replacement of the drug.

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ENTERTAINMENT





Night of the Jack is Back... and Bringing a Carnival!

Night of the Jack returns to King Gilette Ranch with an all-new reimagined one-mile trail unlike anything you've ever seen before. Step into a cinematic world of glowing pumpkins, dazzling lights, new immersive displays and unexpected adventures around every corner! Kicking off on September 25, this will run until November 1.

Featuring thousands of hand-carved and illuminated Jack O' lanterns, attendees will weave their way through an array of cleverly-crafted pumpkin patches, one-of-a-kind lantern art and projection mapping that displays some spooktacular sights. This production takes place on a three-quarter mile stretch of pathways, so participants can stroll at their leisure while sipping a themed cocktail from the Spookeasy bar. With new carving styles and returning favorites, you'll weave your way through the land of dinosaurs, classic movie monsters, alien life and more.

New this year is Jack's Carnival, featuring 10+ rides, attractions and festive games. Featured attractions include the world's largest bounce house, an inflatable slide, a corn maze, ballistic swings, a fun house and much more! Guests must have a valid Night of the Jack admission ticket to access Jack's Carnival. While entry into the carnival is included with the ticket, each guest must purchase an individual carnival wristband to enjoy unlimited rides. This can be done online when purchasing the main event ticket or at the venue.

Lantern installations pepper the trail where guests can stop for a photo moment or swing by the pumpkinized photo op where you'll be able to sit inside of the art piece and capture that special Halloween photo moment! Arrive early (and hungry) to indulge in the array of food trucks available.

The venue opens at 6 pm and closes at 10:30 pm, with designated time slots. Advance ticket purchase is required and guests may have to deal with an extended wait time to enter the patch given the heavy volume of attendees this season. Tickets start at $29.35 (plus fees) and parking is $15.98, which must be purchased alongside event tickets.

Night of the Jack is located at 26800 West Mulholland Hwy. For tickets, and more info, visit nightofthejack.com.

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WOODLAND HILLS

The Outsiders Breaks Into Pantages September 30

Four-time Tony Award winner *The Outsiders* is coming to the Pantages Theatre September 30 through October 18.

Winner of Best Musical, *The Outsiders* is adapted from S.E. Hinton's seminal novel and Francis Ford Coppola's iconic film.



Hinton's first novel, which she wrote when she was a high school student, addresses themes of violence, masculinity and belonging, all of which Hinton witnessed first-hand with her childhood friends. This coming-of-age story was inspired by her experiences growing up in Oklahoma and witnessing the rivalries between local gangs.

In 1967's Tulsa, Ponyboy Curtis, his best friend Johnny Cade and their Greaser family of "outsiders" battle with their affluent rivals, the Socs. *The Outsiders* navigates the complexities of self-discovery as the Greasers dream about who they want to become in a world that may never accept them.

The new musical features a book by Adam Rapp with Justin Levine, music and lyrics by James-town Revival (Jonathan Clay and Zach Chance) and Tony Award winner Justin Levine, music supervision, orchestration, and arrangements by Justin Levine, choreography by Rick Kuperman and Jeff Kuperman, and direction by Tony Award® winner Danya Tamor.

For tickets, visit broadwayinhollywood.com.



Nighttrek: What to See in the October Sky

By Neill Simmons

October is an excellent month for stargazing! Darkness arrives much earlier in the evening, autumn often brings stable, crisp, and clear atmospheric conditions, and the temperatures are usually mild.

One of the highlights of October is the appearance of the planet Saturn. It will rise in the east after sunset. Saturn is known for its large and beautiful rings. There are a total of seven rings which are made up of 99% ice and bits of rock and dust. The rings are only about 30 feet thick. They look so big because they are incredibly wide. Saturn's rings can be seen with powerful binoculars or a telescope.

On October 12 look in the west to see the beautiful thin crescent Moon bordered by the planets Mercury and Venus. Mercury and Venus are the only two planets in our solar system that do not have any natural moons.

The full Moon will appear on October 26. This full Moon is known as the Hunter's Moon. It gets this traditional name because the fields are harvested by late October. Animals are plump from leftover crops and the bright moonlight historically helped hunters spot game in the open fields.

There are two meteor showers in October. The Draconid meteor shower peaks on October 8 and is produced by debris from Comet 21P/ Giacobini-Zinner. The Draconid shower is best viewed in the evening right after nightfall and viewing conditions are excellent this year with minimal moonlight.

The Orionid meteor shower peaks on October 21. These meteors are formed from dust grains left behind by Halley's Comet.

NASA launched a super space telescope. The new telescope was named for Nancy Grace Roman, a groundbreaking scientist and NASA's first chief astronomer, who helped create the US space program. The telescope, named Roman, will travel about a million miles from Earth before reaching its orbit. NASA expects to release its first images in early 2027.

The constellation of Cassiopeia, the queen, is visible this month in the northeast sky. Cassiopeia was one of the 48 constellations detailed by the Greek astronomer Ptolemy in the 2nd century CE. The constellation is most notable because of its W shape, which is said to represent the queen sitting on her throne.

On Saturday, October 17 at 7 pm, the Ventura County Astronomical Society will host a FREE Star Party at Paramount Ranch located at 2903 Cornell Road, Agoura Hills. The event is outdoors so it may get chilly. Only red flashlights are allowed. Please no pets. There will be lots of telescopes for viewing the night sky and amateur astronomers will be available to share their knowledge.

The Draconid meteor shower peaks on October 8. The Orionid meteor shower peaks on October 21.

Also on October 17, the Griffith Park Observatory will host a FREE Star Party from 2 pm to 9:45 pm. This is a chance for the whole family to look at the sun, Moon, visible planets, and other objects, to try out a variety of telescopes, and to talk to knowledgeable amateur astronomers about the sky and their equipment.

Neill Simmons is available to answer your astronomy questions. He may be reached at neill.simmons@gmail.com.



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